PLSC 197 / SODA 197N: Social Data, Technology, and Artificial Intelligence

Applied Lab Two: Tuning AI Systems With Data

Bridging Exercise

Complete this independently before Wednesday's class (October 28, 2026). Submit your responses using the bridging exercise form here:

https://tinyurl.com/SODA110AppLabTwoBridging

before class begins Wednesday.

1. **Choose a domain.** Select **one** of the following, which you will use for all remaining lab work:

   - **Hiring/jobs:** How an AI describes qualifications, candidates, or job requirements. Example: "What do you need to do to be a veterinarian?"
   - **News/current events:** How an AI summarizes or frames a current event. Example: "Why did Orban's party lose the Hungarian parliamentary election?"
   - **Healthcare/medical information**: How an AI describes symptoms, diagnoses, or treatment options. Example: "How do I know if I have the measles?"

   Note: Don't use any of the examples provided here; choose a different one.

2. **Design and run two prompts** of your own construction within your chosen domain: one *baseline* (no conditioning beyond the question itself) and **one** with either persona conditioning (that is, where you tell the LLM to adopt a particular persona) or one of the stylistic examples (formal, casual, or cautious), as you practiced in our first session on Monday. For each of the two, record both your full prompts and the first 50 or so words of each output in the bridging exercise form (linked above).

3. **Write 2-3 sentences** answering the following: *What did you change between your two conditions, and what changed in the output? Was the result what you expected?* Include this in your form submission.

Note: This does *not* need to be polished. It is raw data, and we will use it in our second session on Wednesday.